

GREAT VALUE — Imperial Fists

Detachments	Emper
	Purge
Disposition	telepo
	~1,98
	Land S
Total	have h

Identity

A REVERSE-KNIGHT: instead of 5-6 big mode
 Oath of Moment names ONE enemy unit/tur
 that target. Wrapped around an OC22 Termini
 AP-2 cyclone missiles, and mobile Land Speeder
 and rarely gets out-scored — it grinds you down
 blunts ONE attacker's AP-by-1 on ONE unit, c
 occasional, well-timed tool, not a passive.

Unit	x
Terminator Assault Squad (TH/SS)	10
Darnath Lysander	1
Ancient in Terminator Armour	1
Terminator Squad (2x Cyclone)	10
Librarian in Terminator Armour	1
Sternguard Veteran Squad	10
Librarian	1
Land Speeder (Multi-melta)	2

Intercessor Squad	5
Bladeguard Veteran Squad	5
Vanguard Veteran Squad (Jump)	2

s · Emperor's Shield + Librarius Conclave

or's Shield (2 DP) + Librarius Conclave (1 DP) = 3 DP

the Foe (kill-weighted — fits the durable convergence gunline). Hidden deploy + reserve-heavy
rt/deep-strike alpha.

5 / 2000 (the friend's actual build). Points MFM-verified where present; * = SM MFM is missing Sterr
Speeder / Vanguard Veterans (same incompleteness we hit for Knights) so those are meta-doc estim
him confirm exact points/counts vs his app.

ils, ~50-60 elite bodies that are hard to kill and hard to move. The win-con is CONVERGENCE, not r
n and the whole army re-rolls Hits + adds +1 to Wound into it — roughly DOUBLING every unit's ou
nator brick (Lysander) that one-rounds anything in melee, an unsaveable Sternguard Dev-Wound c
æder melta. Defence: 2+/4++ (the real workhorse) + sticky objectives + hidden deploy. It rarely ge
own and holds what it takes. NOTE: Armour of Contempt is NOT army-wide durability — it's a 1-CP !
once per phase, and only helps vs AP-1/-2 (nothing vs high-AP/invuln/Dev). With only ~1 CP/turn it's

Role

+ Darnath Lysander + Ancient in Terminator Armour = the OC22 BRICK. Thunder hammer S8
AP-2 D2 [Dev]; ~24-28 melee one-rounds ANY target. M5, Teleport Homer. NOT battle-shock-
immune (see below).

Warlord. Inspiring Commander -> non-Character Terminators become OC2 (brick = OC22 while
intact). Icon of Obstinacy (-1 to wound at S>=5). Gives NO battle-shock immunity.

Banner: +OC + re-roll a hit/wound; keeps the brick fighting on death.

+ Librarian in Terminator Armour [Fusillade]. #1 RANGED threat: krak missile S9 AP-2 + cyclone;
Fusillade = Lethal Hits. ~one-shots an Armiger.

Leads the cyclone brick; Fusillade (Lethal Hits) + a Conclave Discipline/round.

+ Librarian [Temporal Corridor]. The UNSAVEABLE chipper: Sternguard bolt rifle S4 AP-1 D1 [Dev,
RF1] + FULL wound-reroll vs Oath -> ~5-7 mortal wounds/turn skipping any invuln. It CLEARS
W1/W2 UNITS wholesale — but has NO Precision, so it can't snipe an attached Character; that's
Lysander + Epic Challenge in melee.

Temporal Corridor (move-the-Sternguard reserve/reposition) + a Discipline.

Multi-melta S9 AP-4 D6 [Melta 2], 2 shots ea. Armiger/vehicle killer. HAVE DEEP STRIKE (a 3rd
arrival threat). M14 mobile.

T4 W2 OC10 STICKY (Objective Secured / Wrathful Conquerors) — the objective stays his after they die. Bolt rifle volume.

3+/4++ OC + Teleport Homers; forward pressure / brick support.

OC5, M12, Teleport Homers — army-wide OC + forward homers that enable the teleport alpha.



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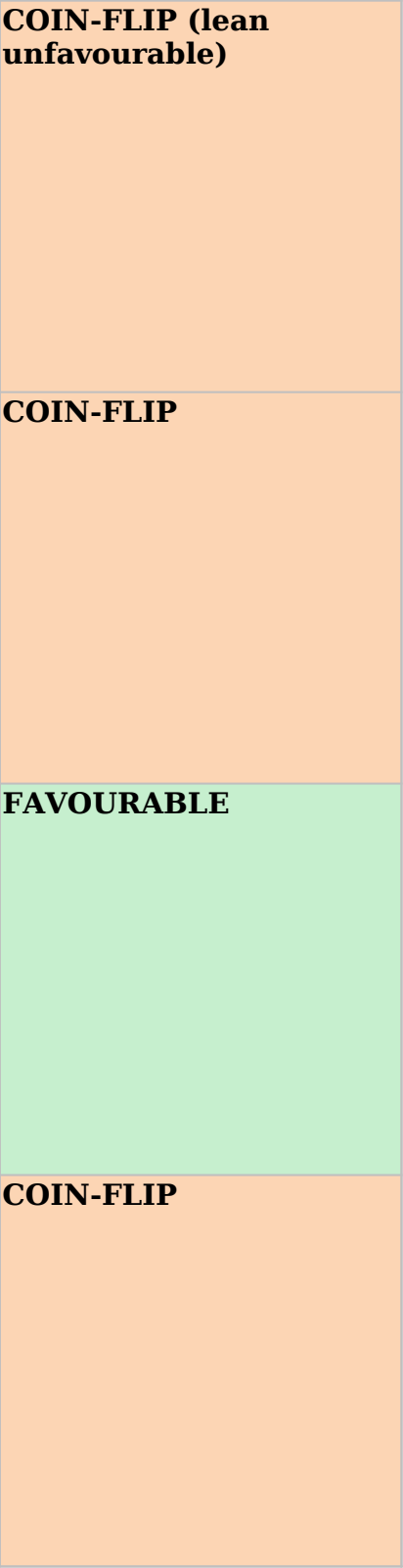
80
80
~180*

GREAT VALUE vs the meta (n=70 listhammer, GV's pe			
Faction	Archetype	Prev.	
Emperor's Children	Frenzied Host / Coterie (Defiler + swarm)	High (9)	
Orks	Green Tide (~100 bodies)	High (8)	
Adeptus Mechanicus	Rad-Zone / Lords of the Forge gunline	High (6)	
T'au Empire	Retaliation Cadre (fusion/rail alpha)	High (5)	

Necrons	Awakened Dynasty (C'tan + Wraiths)	Med (4)
Adeptus Custodes	Lions of the Emperor (elite melee)	Med (4)
Blood Angels	Stormlance / Liberator jump alpha	Med (4)
Dark Angels	Deathwing Knights / Inner Circle	Med (3-4)

Drukhari	Skysplinter Assault (fast splinter + lance)	Med (3)
Astra Militarum	Steel Hammer superheavy / artillery	Low-Med (2)

perspective)
Verdict
FAVOURABLE
COIN-FLIP (your hardest common matchup)
FAVOURABLE
COIN-FLIP -> favourable (the alpha is REAL)



FAVOURABLE
FAVOURABLE

Deciding factor / game plan

Your 2+/4++ + Armour of Contempt tanks the Infractor/Daemonette melee that shreds W1 armies; Oath + Sternguard Dev delete the Defilers and the Lord Exultants; the brick one-rounds Fulgrim/Keeper if they commit. Their AP-1/-2 volume is the wrong shape for TEQ.

PLAN: • Oath the Defiler each turn (it's the only thing that hurts your armour) — Sternguard Dev + cyclone remove one/turn. • Let the Daemonette/Infractor chaff crash into the brick; it holds and swings back for ~49. Don't chase. • Sticky your objectives; grind. They can't out-durable or out-score you — win on attrition.

WATCH: Fulgrim (Fights First, -1 to hit) + Maulerfiends can trade into a brick; Oath them before they charge.

The ONE army that out-BODIES and out-OCs you. ~100 Boyz + 5++ + power claws flood the board; your OC22 brick holds 1-2 objectives but they blanket the rest, and claws crack even Terminators. Your shooting mows Boyz but can't clear 100.

PLAN: • Do NOT try to out-OC the horde — concede the middle, hold your 2 bricks' objectives + sticky what you can. • Oath the biggest brick each turn (Ghazghkull's or the klaw-nob unit); shooting-focus to thin the OC where it decides an objective. • Bricks counter-punch (they survive the claws better than anything); Speeders melta the Kill Rigs/Wazdakka. Race secondaries — you won't out-primary a full horde.

WATCH: Getting tar-pitted and out-actioned; Green Tide is a genuine ~45% — accept it and minimise the margin

Their anti-tank is WASTED on you: Kataphron arc rifle [Anti-Vehicle 4+] and ferrumite do nothing special to INFANTRY, and D6-damage guns over-kill W2-3 bodies. You out-durable (AoC + 2+/4+ +), out-volume, and Oath deletes a Kataphron brick/turn.

PLAN: • Oath a Kataphron brick each turn — Sternguard Dev + cyclone + Speeder melta erase it (no invuln/FNP). • Advance into their M5 gunline; Armour of Contempt shrugs the ferrumite/lascannon. Brick eats Kastelan/Ironstriders in melee. • Out-score — their bodies are few and fragile once the Kataphrons die.

WATCH: Culexus/Callidus sniping your psykers (throttles Conclave); screen the Librarians.

Their anti-elite is Railgun AP-5 / heavy rail AP-4 / fusion AP-4 — NO AP-1, so ARMOUR OF CONTEMPT DOES NOTHING here (AP that high already negates armour; an invuln is never modified by AP). You're on the 4++ ALONE (fails half), and the railgun/rail DEVASTATING WOUNDS turn crits into MORTALS that bypass the 4++ too — a markerlit alpha CAN delete the brick. Your edge isn't your saves, it's RESERVES (few T1 targets) + T'au fragility: Oath one-rounds Crisis/Riptides and the brick walks down anything that lingers. Survive the alpha, then out-grind.

PLAN: • Reserve heavy + hide the brick from first-turn rail/fusion LoS — the alpha can't hurt what it can't see. (Don't waste CP on Armour of Contempt vs their AP-4/-5; it does nothing.) • In YOUR Command phase each turn, Oath the biggest suit unit ON THE BOARD (Sternguard Dev + cyclone + brick erase it). You commit PROACTIVELY — you CANNOT Oath a unit the turn it deep-strikes in (that's the opponent's turn). • Grind forward: T'au can't out-durable or out-melee you. Kill

C'tan durability (4+/-1Dmg/reanim) blunts even your convergence, and they out-OC with reanimating bodies. Your edge: Sternguard Dev MORTALS partly bypass reanimation, and the brick out-fights Wraiths. But you can't table 3 C'tan and they grind objectives.

PLAN: • Oath + Sternguard Dev a C'tan each turn — mortals skip the 4++; you won't kill it but you suppress it. • Don't feed the brick into the Void Dragon (Anti-Veh, heals off you); brick kills Wraiths/Lychguard instead. • Win on sticky objectives + secondaries; it's a grind you can steal, not a matchup you dominate.

WATCH: Reanimation refunding your chip — focus-remove whole units, don't spread. BATTLE-SHOCK: their 1CP C'tan strat forces the OC22 brick to test at -1 (+D3+1 mortals on fail) -> a failed test zeroes its OC and shuts off its strats on the turn you most need it holding. Hold 1 CP for Mirror of elites: their 2+/4++ + better melee weapons vs your 2+/4++ + more bodies + Oath + unsaveable Sternguard. They out-fight the brick model-for-model; you out-number and out-shoot (Dev bypasses their 4++).

PLAN: • Do NOT brawl the Blade Champion/Wardens with the brick head-on — Oath + Sternguard Dev SHOOT them down (mortals skip the 4++). • Use your body count + sticky OC to out-score; they have ~40 models, you have more. • Speeders melta the Caladius; cyclone + Oath delete a Custodian unit/turn.

WATCH: Trajann/Blade Champion out-duel Lysander AND are ATTACHED (you can't snipe them) — grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, or use EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP) to give Lysander's Fist [PRECISION] and kill the character in melee. Don't feed Lysander in unbuffed. Glass melee alpha into your armour: Death Company/Sang Guard hit hard on the charge but fold to return fire, and Armour of Contempt + 4++ blunts their AP. Oath + overwatch thin the alpha as it lands; the brick counter-punches.

PLAN: • Screen so the DC/Sang Guard land 9"+ out and can't reach a T2 charge (overwatch thins them). Then on YOUR turn Oath the landed unit and gun it down — you can't Oath it as it arrives in their turn. • Weather the charge behind 2+/4++/AoC; the brick one-rounds Dante/Sanguinary Guard back. • Out-grind — they're fragile once the alpha is spent.

WATCH: Lemartes/Priests are ATTACHED to the DC/Sang-Guard (you CANNOT target them) — grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, or Lysander + EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP -> [PRECISION]) to assassinate the buff-char in melee.

Terminator mirror: their Deathwing Knights (4++, mace, Smite of the Watchers) + Lion vs your Lysander brick + Sternguard. Both durable; comes down to Oath efficiency + who out-scores. The Lion out-duels Lysander in melee.

PLAN: • SHOOT the Deathwing down with Oath + Sternguard Dev (mortals skip the 4++) — don't melee the mace brick. • Race objectives; both armies are slow, so board position + sticky OC decide it. • Speeders + cyclone delete the Ravenwing speeders / support first.

WATCH: The Lion is a STANDALONE Monster (directly targetable) — Oath + shoot him down at range (no Precision needed). Do NOT feed Lysander into him in melee.

Fragile paper into your armour: their dark lances are few and their Lethal/pain tokens are non-Vehicle (do little to TEQ); Armour of Contempt + 4++ tanks the splinter. Oath + volume deletes their transports and infantry wholesale.

PLAN: • Oath a Venom/Ravager or the Incubi each turn — shooting erases their paper. • Weather the T2 lance alpha behind AoC; brick counter-charges the Incubi/Wyches. • Their speed can out-manoeuve — hold sticky objectives so they can't just flip the board late.

WATCH: Being out-actioned by their mobility; keep your homers/screens tight so they can't backfield-raid.

Their lascannon/volcano over-kills your W2-3 bodies (D6 into W2 = waste), and their infantry can't out-fight yours. You advance behind AoC, Oath the superheavies (or ignore and out-score), and the brick/Speeders crack the tanks.

PLAN: • Reserve vs the alpha; advance into the gunline (they're static). Oath the Shadowsword/Baneblade or just out-score around it. • Speeder melta + brick delete a superheavy if it's the win-con; otherwise take objectives their tanks can't hold. • Sticky OC + body count out-scores a low-model Guard tank list.

WATCH: Artillery + Leontus orders can chip. Spread bodies to limit mortal/spillover from the big guns — but note spreading does NOT reduce a [BLAST] weapon's shots (Blast = +1 attack per 5 models IN the target unit regardless of spacing); to cut Blast you bring smaller units

DATA-DRIVEN SIM — GV vs the meta (Oath output from data/bsdata/wh.mathhammer)

800 games/archetype. tools/mc_gv_sim.py. Oath dmg = GV's Oath-boosted convergence (priority target/turn; brick = the Lysander charge. Indicative — coin-flips are the practice run

Archetype	Prev.	Verdict	Oath dmg	Brick melee
Emperor's Children (Defiler+swarm)	9	FAV	15	35
Orks (Green Tide horde)	8	COIN	34	61
AdMech (Rad-Zone gunline)	6	FAV	29	46
T'au (Retaliation alpha)	5	COIN	14	30
Necrons (Awakened C'tan)	4	COIN-	13	29
Custodes (elite melee)	4	COIN	17	36
Blood Angels (jump alpha)	4	FAV	30	46
Dark Angels (Deathwing)	3	COIN	17	36
Drukhari (Skysplinter)	3	FAV	21	41
Astra Militarum (superheavy)	2	FAV	16	30

Prevalence-weighted GV win rate $\approx$ 59% — strong all-comers; hardest = Orks horde

a via

onto the
matchups.

GV win%
61%
27%
77%
66%
33%
67%
67%
77%
78%
74%

rde.

THE TAPESTRY — how G

Thread
Oath of Moment (THE engine)
Lysander — Inspiring Commander
Wrath of Dorn (Emperor's Shield)
Armour of Contempt (defence)
Sternguard Focus (unsaveable)
Teleport / Deep-Strike engines
Librarius Conclave
The alpha math
The soft underbelly
Killing characters (NO Precision)
CP economy (~2/round)
Battle-shock — GV's HIDDEN weakness
Core strats cut BOTH ways

MINDSET

GV is 'always outnumbered by bi and rarely get out-scored. Play th helps only vs AP-1/-2 volume, NC getting out-BODIED/out-OC'd by (3) getting BATTLE-SHOCKED by switch off. Deploy your homers to you can't finish.

RECORD

Great Value is a STRONG all-com GT: a solidly positive record, ~4- OBJECTIVES, not by any single al the M5 bricks and out-scores whi don't strand the bricks. Blind spo dependent (Conclave) -> Culexu: charges / scattered homers) is a

reat Value wins

What it does

Each Command phase name ONE enemy unit -> the whole army re-rolls Hits AND (mono-IF) adds +1 to it. ~DOUBLES every unit's damage onto the Oathed target. Convergence, not raw guns, is how GV kills.

Non-Character Terminators in his unit become OC2 -> the 10-brick is OC20 (+Lysander +Ancient = OC22). INTACT. It won't take a Command-phase battle-shock test until below half strength (6+ dead), so vs mortals the OC22 holds. But Lysander grants NO battle-shock immunity: a FORCED test (see Battle-shock entry) at full strength -> OC drops to '1' (0), so all that OC evaporates.
Re-roll a Wound-roll of 1 army-wide + FULL wound re-roll for Lysander's unit. Stacks with Oath.

-1 AP to incoming attacks (stratagem). Drops enemy AP-2 -> AP-1; brutal vs AP-1/-2 VOLUME (the core BUT does NOTHING vs AP-4/-5 (armour already negated) or whenever you're taking an INVULN save (which modifies an invuln), and NOTHING vs Devastating/mortal wounds -- so it does not save you from railgun snipes.
vs the Oathed unit, Sternguard get FULL wound re-roll -> every crit-6 = a Devastating mortal wound. Mortals/turn that skip ANY invuln/Ion Shield. Their teleport-arrival turn is their WEAKEST shoot.

THREE arrival threats: Sternguard teleport (Temporal Corridor), Land Speeder Deep Strike, Teleport-Hover (Vanguard/Bladeguard). Reserve-heavy hidden alpha lands turn 2 within homer range.

Each round pick 1 Discipline; ALL friendly ADEPTUS ASTARTES PSYKER units get it until end of round. Librarian-led Sternguard + the Librarian-in-Term cyclone brick — NOT the Lysander brick, it has no power from the pack: Biomancy = +2" M / Divination = re-roll Hit-1s AND Wound-1s / Pyromancy = +1 AP v. mortals within 12" / Telekinesis = -1 S to ranged attacks INTO the unit (defensive) / Telepathy = ignore BS/M. Full-stack into an Oathed target ~30-34 (10+ unsaveable Sternguard Dev); the Lysander brick (full Wound Oath) ~49 melee -> one-rounds ANY single model, even a 4++.

Everything hangs on the SOFT LEGS (Sternguard, Land Speeders, cyclone Termies, Vanguard) + the bricks. Kill the legs -> the convergence collapses; out-mobile the bricks -> the board opens.

Sternguard/cyclone/brick have NO [PRECISION] -> you canNOT snipe a Character attached to a Bodyguard (wounds hit the bodyguard). Tools: (1) grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, exposing the character to CHALLENGE (core strat 15.03, 1CP) -> Lysander's Fist gains [PRECISION] to assassinate an ATTACHED MELEE. (2) STANDALONE Monster/Titanic char (Fulgrim/Magnus/Lion/superheavy) = shoot DIRECTLY. 1 CP at the start of EACH player-turn (~10/game) + CP-model/discard extras. Oath of Moment is FREE BUT Armour of Contempt, Fury of the First, Disciplined Extermination, Dropship Extraction, Wrathful Challenge AND Epic Challenge all COMPETE for ~1 strat/turn -> you cannot fire them all. Each turn pick ONE primary offence convergence strat, OR defensive AoC, OR Epic Challenge, and hold CP for the swing turn.
Core 01.07: a battle-shocked unit has OC '1' (0), CANNOT be targeted by ANY stratagem, and cannot perform Actions. GV's ENTIRE win-con is the OC22 brick out-scoring you on objectives -> shock it and that collapses you shut off his defensive strats on it (no AoC/Rotate-equivalent on a shocked unit). Lysander gives M His mitigations: Insane Bravery (core 15.04, 1CP, auto pass ONE test, > competes for the same CP as Oath). Every army at LSO has the same 12 core stratagems (Section 15): Command Re-roll, Counter-offensive Challenge, Insane Bravery, Grenade, Tank Shock, Fire Overwatch, Smokescreen, Heroic Intervention, Go to Ground, Armour of Contempt. So the OPPONENT can Epic-Challenge to snipe GV's characters in Counter-offensive to fight first, Rapid Ingress to steal the alpha, and Fire Overwatch the teleport drop.

g things, never out-graunched by small ones.' You are the DURABLE, STICKY, all-comers list — you run the OATH like a sniper (one perfect target/turn), weather the enemy's alpha behind 2+/4++ (Armour or AT railguns/fusion/Dev), and win the LONG GAME on sticky objectives + attrition. Your THREE failure modes: (1) a true horde, (2) getting out-MANOEUVRED and out-scored by a faster army while your M5 bricks are a shock-weaponizer (Tyrannids/CSM/Necrons/Daemons) -> the OC22 brick drops to OC0 and its defense is out of control WHERE the alpha lands; hold 1 CP for Insane Bravery vs shock decks; never waste the Oath

ers list — a better raw record expectation than a Knight army because it has FEWER hard counters. Runs 2 to 5-1 over 5-6 rounds, with a genuine shot at the top tables. It wins by DURABILITY + CONVERGENCE. The two things that beat it: a true HORDE that out-bodies the OC (Orks) and a fast army that out-lets the refusing the fight (kite-and-flip). Its own discipline test: pilot the Oath perfectly (one finishable target): (1) M5 bricks are slow -> board control depends on the mobile legs + homers, protect them; (2) p...s/Callidus/character-snipes throttle it, screen the Librarians; (3) reserve-heavy -> a whiffed turn-2 army lost tempo swing.